MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, HEANEY

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of suture needle holder of the Heaney design for use in holding needle during procedure of suturing.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

GG-1-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Box, Set-up.

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case, and Sheet Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof; Flexible.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Copies of specifications and standards, required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions, should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General Requirements. The holder shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526 and the following option exercises under that specification:

3.2 Material. The holder proper shall be fabricated from Class 4, Type 420 material. Jaw inserts (or material plated onto the inside of the jaws) shall be tungsten carbide.

3.3 Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the holder shall have a Rockwell hardness of C40 to C45, with the exception of the screw or pin, for the holder proper. Tungsten carbide insert shall have a Rockwell hardness of A80 minimum when removed from the jaw of a completed instrument.

3.4 Style, design and dimensions. Shall be a suture needle holder of the Heaney design. Serrated inserts shall be brazed to the jaw with a uniform flow of silver solder and be free of crevices at all interfaces. As an alternate, the serrated inside surfaces of the jaws shall be flame plated with a deposit of tungsten carbide material. Thickness of plating shall be 0.004 $\pm$ .001 inch. Shall be in accordance with Figure 1.

3.4.1 Locks. Shall be box type lock.

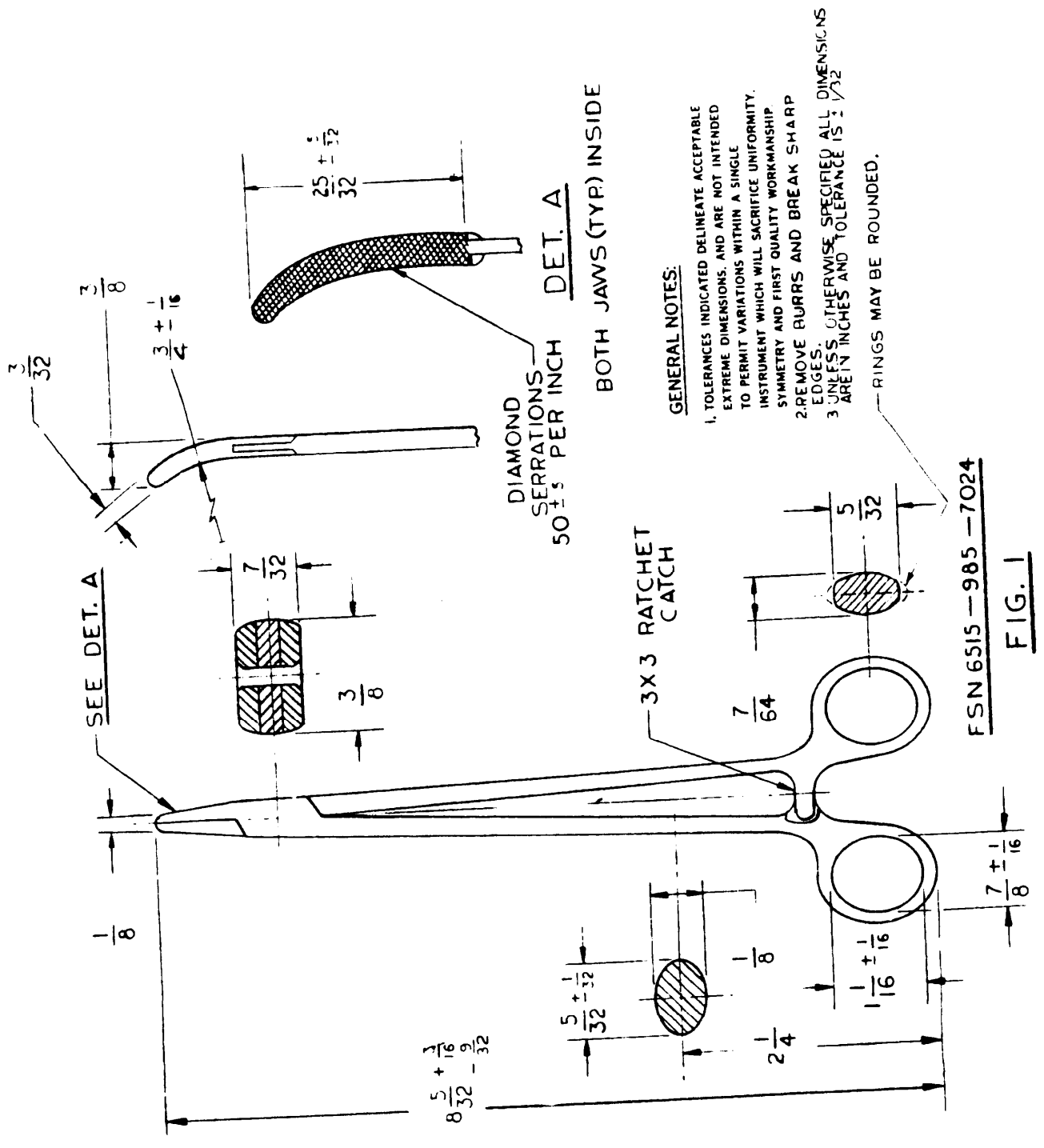
3.5 Finish. Finish shall be mirror or satin for the holder except the inserts. Locks and ratchets shall be smooth and shall be polished, but need not be buffed to a mirror finish.

3.6 Lock stiffness. Holder of box lock construction shall have shanks tested for lock stiffness in accordance with GG-I-526.

3.7 Identification marking. In addition to GG-I-526 requirements, holder of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

3.8 Jaw and ratchet operation. When tested as specified in 4.4.1, the jaw tips shall close first and progressively tighten with each ratchet position. Each ratchet position shall hold firmly and release instantly.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with GG-I-526.

4.1.2 Records. Records of examination and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion resisting steel, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificates shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, the individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one holder.

Table I. Sampling Criteria for Examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (Percent defective)
Major	S-4	1.0
Minor	S-4	2.5

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in Table II. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one holder.

Table II. Sampling Criteria for Tests

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL
1 - Holder	Composition analysis	3.2 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	**	*
	Hardness	3.3 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Dimensions including clearances (crevices)	3.4	--------	S-2	2.5
	Boil test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Copper sulfate	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Box lock	3.6	GG-I-526	II	6.5
	Stiffness				
	Distortion test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	2.5
	Jaw and ratchet operation test	3.8	4.4.1	S-2	1.0

* Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.

** Four ounces of each lot of metal used in the construction of the holder shall be selected for chemical analysis. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

4.3 Examination. The holder shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Table I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in Table III. Any holder in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective items in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for test sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

Table III. Classification of Defects

Categories	
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Holder not of box lock construction.
102	Serrations of both jaws not meshing with each other in fully closed position.
103	Holder not free from excessive play in box lock area.
104	Ratchet and ratchet catches do not easily engage and disengage at each ratchet position.
105	Ratchet and ratchet catches do not lock securely.
Minor	
201	Holder not identified as specified.
202	Holder not free from foreign matter (polishing material)
203	Finish not as specified.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Jaw and operation test. The holder shall be positioned to the first ratchet position, but not locked. Holder with jaw tips not touching shall be rejected. Holder that does not progressively tighten with each ratchet advance shall be rejected.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One holder as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table IV shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table IV. Packaging Quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	6 units	144 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units may be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Cleaning and drying. Each unit shall be thoroughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable method as outlined in MIL-P-116.

5.1.3.2 Preservative. Preservative shall not be utilized.

5.1.3.3 Intimate wrap. Each unit shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive material.

5.1.3.4 Unit package. Each unit shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-1.

5.1.3.5 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676, except commercial colors will be acceptable, or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening under normal handling.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20261O-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Special requirements as specified in Table II of PPP-B-636 shall apply for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraph of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed in accordance with 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

NOTE: Strapping shall not be required for shipments forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Closure of fiberboard boxes shall conform to method II as specified in PPP-B-636. In addition, fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Shall be a needle holder of the Heaney design which is for use in holding needle during procedure of suturing.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number, title and date of this specification.

(b) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 National Stock Number (NSN) coverage. This specification covers the following items listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-00-985-7024	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Heaney, 8-½ inch

It does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

6.4 Supersession data. This specification includes the requirements of Purchase Description No. 2, dated 24 October 1968 for NSN 6515-00-985-7024 Holder, Suture Needle, Heaney, 8-½ inch.

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-1796

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS. The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers' vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-H-37029

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426 REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 68 WHICH MAY BE USED

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEFENSE SUPPLY AGENCY
DoD - 304

U.S. MAIL

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

FOLD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T09:49Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.